



Northbridge Community Alliance

Internal Operations & Policy Reference

(For Staff Use)

1. Pantry Access & Eligibility

Who is eligible to receive pantry services?

Households residing in Northbridge and surrounding zip codes (14621, 14609, 14613) are eligible. Proof of residency (ID, utility bill, lease) is requested but not required on first visit. Self-attestation is permitted for initial intake.

How often may a household visit the pantry?

- Standard frequency: Once per calendar month.
- Exception: Biweekly visits permitted for households with 5+ members or documented SNAP interruption.
- Emergency override: Staff discretion (requires supervisor approval).

2. Pantry Hours & Pickup Options

Operating Hours:

- Tuesday: 9:00am–1:00pm
- Thursday: 12:00pm–6:00pm
- Saturday: 10:00am–2:00pm

Is evening pickup available?

Yes — Thursday hours extend to 6:00pm.

Is proxy pickup allowed?

Yes. A designated proxy may pick up on behalf of a household with written note or text confirmation, household name and address, and proxy ID.



3. Delivery Policy

Delivery is limited and available only for households with verified mobility constraints, medically homebound individuals, or temporary housing placements without transportation.

Delivery requests must be submitted at least 48 hours in advance. Same-day delivery is not available.

4. Dietary Accommodations

- The pantry cannot guarantee strict compliance with religious or medical dietary standards.
- Staff may provide substitutions when available.
- Nut-free requests are prioritized when documented.
- Lower-sodium and higher-protein substitutions may be accommodated depending on inventory.
- All dietary accommodations are subject to current stock levels.

5. Inventory & Substitution Rules

When inventory falls below 25% of par level, item limits may be temporarily reduced, substitutions may be provided, and partner organizations may be notified.

Current high-demand categories (February 2026):

- Infant formula
- Peanut butter
- Diapers (sizes 4–6)
- Shelf-stable protein

Inventory status should be confirmed with warehouse dashboard before communicating guarantees.



6. Bulk & Event Requests

- Requests must be submitted at least 7 days in advance.
- Maximum bulk allocation: 50 households equivalent per month per organization.
- Shelf-stable items only.
- Dependent on surplus inventory.
- Bulk support may be denied during periods of low stock.

7. Temporary Housing & Limited Kitchen Facilities

- Microwave only: Provide ready-to-heat meals, rice pouches, canned meals with pop-tops.
- Mini-fridge only: Provide smaller volume, high-rotation items.
- No can opener: Avoid standard cans unless opener provided.
- Package customization must be noted in intake record.

8. Donation Intake Standards

- Non-expired, sealed items.
- At least 3 months before expiration (preferred).
- No damaged packaging.
- No home-canned goods.
- Large donation drop-offs must be scheduled in advance.

9. Referral Coordination

Partner referrals should include household size, mobility/dietary considerations, and preferred pickup timing. Households must complete intake upon first visit.





10. SNAP & Benefits Gaps

- SNAP interruption qualifies for biweekly pantry visits.
- Documentation not required for first override.
- Staff should provide SNAP recertification assistance referral information.

11. Communication Standards

- Avoid guaranteeing specific items unless inventory is confirmed.
- Use conditional language when appropriate.
- Clearly state hours and documentation requirements.
- Clarify if request requires supervisor approval.

